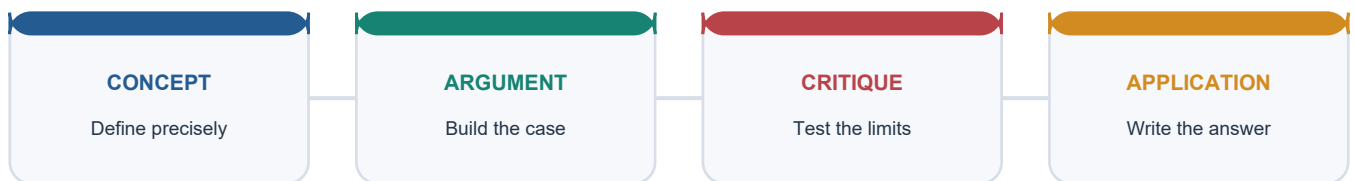


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC solved practice workbook | MCQs, timeline drills, keywords and full model answers

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

CORE UPSC MCQS

Q1. Which site-feature pair is correctly matched?

A. Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath and integrated drainage emphasis B. Lothal - securely identified royal palace C. Dholavira - absence of reservoirs D. Kalibangan - exact copy of Mohenjo-daro in all details

Answer: A. Explanation: Mohenjo-daro is the classic site for the Great Bath and strong drainage evidence. Lothal's famous basin is debated, Dholavira is well known for reservoirs, and Kalibangan represents regional variation rather than perfect duplication.

Q2. Which sequence keeps archaeological phase history separate from modern recovery history?

A. Early Harappan -> 1921 Harappa excavation -> Mature Urban phase -> 2021 UNESCO B. Early Harappan -> Mature Urban phase -> Late/Post-Urban change; separately, 1853 seal notice -> 1921 Harappa excavation -> 2021 UNESCO C. 1921 Harappa excavation -> Late Harappan phase -> 1853 seal notice D. UNESCO 2021 -> Early Harappan -> Cunningham 1853

Answer: B. Explanation: The first chain is the civilisation's own chronology; the second is the modern discovery and heritage chronology. The other options collapse two different timelines into one.

Q3. Which of the following best represents the classification given for Harappan buildings in this topic?

A. Stupas, monasteries and chaityas B. Temples, tanks and gopurams C. Dwelling houses, public buildings and public baths D. Palaces, pyramids and ziggurats

Answer: C. Explanation: The Harappan classification in the core source is exactly this three-part division. The other options belong to later Indian architecture or other Bronze Age civilisations.

Q4. A grid of streets meeting at right angles most safely supports which inference?

A. One named Harappan king is known. B. Every Harappan town had identical size. C. Harappan religion is fully recoverable. D. The settlements were pre-planned rather than organically accumulated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Right-angled street planning is strong evidence of prior layout. It does not, by itself, identify rulers, theology or identical city size.

Q5. Which statement about the citadel-lower town distinction is most defensible?

A. It suggests functional zoning within a planned settlement. B. It proves a fully known caste hierarchy. C. It proves a palace-temple state. D. It shows that the lower town lacked planned houses.

Answer: A. Explanation: Functional zoning is the safest inference. The other options overread the evidence or directly contradict the planned nature of Harappan settlements.

Q6. Which material wording is safest after the reopened factual correction?

A. All Harappan construction is best described only through gypsum mortar. B. Harappan architecture shows standardised baked-brick construction; technical mortar or waterproofing details should stay context-specific. C. Stone was the normal Harappan material. D. Harappans avoided brick in public works.

Answer: B. Explanation: The safe general claim is standardised baked-brick construction. The source line on gypsum mortar should not be inflated into a universal formula for every structure.

Q7. Which sequence best captures the drainage logic?

A. Great Bath -> granary -> stepwell -> temple tank B. reservoir -> palace -> shrine -> moat C. house drain -> covered street drain -> cleaning point / cesspit D. private well -> inscription -> fort wall -> dock

Answer: C. Explanation: The Harappan drainage system is meaningful because household outflow linked into a larger street network with built-in maintenance points.

Q8. Which statement is least acceptable in a careful answer on the Great Bath?

A. It is a major public water structure at Mohenjo-daro. B. It is surrounded by associated rooms and galleries. C. It may support an inference of ritual cleansing. D. It is inscriptionally confirmed as a royal temple-tank of a named priesthood.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Great Bath's ritual meaning is inferential, not inscriptionally proven, and neither a named priesthood nor a secure temple label is available.

Q9. What is the safest way to use the word "granary" in Topic 1?

A. As a conventional archaeological label supported by storage-friendly form but still open to caution B. As a securely deciphered Harappan self-name C. As proof of a known royal tax office D. As identical in meaning at every site and phase

Answer: A. Explanation: Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but "granary" remains a modern label rather than a deciphered ancient building name.

Q10. What does the finding "no confirmed palace or temple" most directly imply?

A. Harappans had no religion. B. Harappan authority and belief are not monumentally named in the surviving architectural record. C. Harappans had no authority. D. Egyptian and Mesopotamian evidence is irrelevant.

Answer: B. Explanation: The absence is an evidentiary limit, not a proof of cultural emptiness. It sharpens the comparison with cultures where royal-sacred monuments are explicitly identifiable.

Q11. Why is Dholavira indispensable in a serious Topic 1 answer?

A. It proves every Harappan city was identical. B. It replaces the need to discuss Mohenjo-daro. C. It shows standardisation through regional adaptation, especially via fortifications and reservoirs. D. It disproves Harappan drainage.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dholavira broadens the civilisation-wide thesis from simple uniformity to shared planning norms solved differently in different ecological settings.

Q12. Which statement about Lothal is safest?

A. It is irrelevant to Harappan architecture. B. It had no connection with water questions. C. It proves a deciphered maritime bureaucracy. D. It contains a basin conventionally called a dockyard, but the exact function remains debated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lothal matters, but the architecture answer must preserve the debated status of the basin's function.

Q13. Which statement about domestic architecture is correct?

A. Private wells, designated bathing areas and some stairways show planning reached ordinary houses. B. Domestic architecture was architecturally insignificant. C. Every Harappan house was identical in size and status. D. Domestic evidence exists only at Dholavira.

Answer: A. Explanation: The sources use household wells, bathing spaces and stairs to show that water and planning were distributed into domestic life, though houses did vary.

Q14. Which statement about Meluha is most careful?

A. Meluha is the deciphered Harappan word for their own state. B. Many scholars connect Meluha with the civilisation through Mesopotamian references and seal finds, but it remains an interpretive identification. C. Meluha proves a temple economy. D. Meluha is irrelevant to Harappan urbanism.

Answer: B. Explanation: Trade contact is well supported, but the name remains interpretive rather than a securely recovered self-description from a deciphered Harappan text.

Q15. Which statement most accurately reflects the script ceiling?

A. The undeciphered script lets us confidently name Harappan rulers. B. The script ceiling applies only to sculpture, not architecture. C. The undeciphered script is a major reason architecture cannot by itself settle questions of religion, polity or named institutions. D. The script has no importance for interpretive caution.

Answer: C. Explanation: Architecture gives strong formal evidence, but the unread script and unnamed buildings sharply limit what can be claimed about institutions, kingship and worship.

Q16. Which comparison is sharpest for a Mains answer?

A. Harappan cities had nothing impressive because they lacked pyramids. B. Egypt and Mesopotamia had no planning at all. C. Harappan and Egyptian architecture were identical civic systems. D. Harappan visible surplus is strongest in civic works, whereas Egyptian and Mesopotamian evidence foregrounds royal-sacred monumentality.

Answer: D. Explanation: This is the comparative point that turns description into analysis without making false civilisational judgments.

Q17. Which statement best preserves the water-architecture firewall?

A. Harappan civic water systems and later stepwells or temple tanks should be kept distinct because similar concern with water does not prove one uninterrupted architectural lineage. B. Harappan drains evolved directly into every later Indian stepwell. C. Rani-ki-Vav is a Harappan monument. D. Temple tanks are identical in function to covered street drains.

Answer: A. Explanation: The key is functional distinction: civic sanitation and settlement-wide water planning are not the same as much later ritual, commemorative or patron-centred water architecture.

Q18. Which is locally verified for Rani-ki-Vav in this topic's approved source bank?

A. Exact step count, depth and sculptural programme B. It is a stepwell in Gujarat and a UNESCO World Heritage property C. Full construction date and patron with inscription D. Its direct descent from Harappan drainage

Answer: B. Explanation: The local approved knowledge bank deliberately limits the safe facts here to stepwell, Gujarat and UNESCO status, precisely to avoid invention.

Q19. Which feature is specifically attached to Modhera's Surya Kund in the approved source bank?

A. It is a Mauryan reservoir repaired by Skandagupta. B. It is a Harappan household well. C. It is a step tank near the temple and a distinctive feature of the Solanki school. D. It is the debated basin at Lothal.

Answer: C. Explanation: Modhera's Surya Kund belongs to a much later temple setting and is explicitly presented as a school-defining step tank in the approved Nitin bank.

Q20. Why is the Junagadh/Sudarshana lake record useful in an expanded water answer?

A. It proves Harappan script decipherment. B. It turns every reservoir into a temple tank. C. It removes the need for Dholavira. D. It gives a long inscription-based history of construction and repair across dynasties, showing water maintenance as a durable state concern.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Junagadh record is valuable because it provides rare long-duration evidence for water works as maintained public obligations, though it belongs to a different chronology from Harappan urbanism.

Q21. Which statement about late/post-urban change is safest for Topic 1?

A. Urban planning features weaken, but Topic 1 should not become a single-cause decline argument. B. Late/post-urban change proves one invasion theory. C. The late phase is irrelevant to architecture. D. The late phase makes early and mature distinctions useless.

Answer: A. Explanation: The topic may note weakening of the classic urban package, but full decline debates belong elsewhere and should not dominate an architecture answer.

Q22. Which opening line best fits the verified 2025 PYQ?

A. Harappan trade with Mesopotamia proves a merchant monarchy. B. Harappan architecture is salient because planned grids, zoned settlement, maintainable drains and standardised baked-brick construction together reveal advanced civic urbanism. C. Harappan seals alone explain the architecture. D. The safest answer is to ignore site names entirely.

Answer: B. Explanation: This line selects the main architectural features, frames them analytically and stays inside the evidence.

Q23. Which keyword bundle is most useful to memorise for a direct 10-mark answer?

A. Gopuram, shikhara, mandapa, pradakshina B. horde, janapada, mahajanapada, sangha C. rectangular grid, functional zoning, maintainable drainage, standardised baked-brick construction, evidentiary caution D. cave chaitya, vihara, stupa, torana

Answer: C. Explanation: This set belongs precisely to Harappan architecture and already builds description plus conclusion into the answer plan.

Q24. Which order best represents the paragraph-building method used in the repaired learning session?

A. Qualification -> Claim -> Evidence -> Analysis B. Analysis -> Evidence -> Qualification -> Claim C. Evidence -> Qualification -> Claim -> Analysis D. Claim -> Evidence -> Analysis -> Qualification/Link

Answer: D. Explanation: This sequence helps the student move from a defensible point to named support, then to significance, and finally to a careful limit or direct link to the demand.

Q25. Which modern-recovery statement is correct?

A. Cunningham noticed a Harappan seal in 1853, and Daya Ram Sahni began excavating Harappa in 1921. B. UNESCO discovered Harappa in 2021. C. Dholavira was first excavated by Banerjee in 1921. D. Marshall noticed the first seal before Cunningham.

Answer: A. Explanation: This is the core discovery-history pair the student must remember; the other options distort recovery chronology.

Q26. Which statement about Dholavira's official heritage anchor is correct?

A. UNESCO's official note treats Dholavira only as a temple complex. B. UNESCO's official note recognises Dholavira as a Harappan city with planned urban areas, reservoirs and all three Harappan phases. C. UNESCO says Dholavira belongs only to the late phase. D. UNESCO rejects its water-management significance.

Answer: B. Explanation: The official UNESCO page highlights planned areas, fortifications, reservoirs and early, mature and late Harappan phases.

Q27. Which evidence set most directly supports the civic-priority thesis?

A. Pyramids, imperial inscriptions and royal tombs B. only seals and figurines C. right-angled streets, covered drains, wells, the Great Bath and Dholavira reservoirs D. only the debated basin at Lothal

Answer: C. Explanation: This set shows why Harappan visible investment appears strongest in the organisation of urban life rather than in named royal-sacred monumentality.

Q28. Which statement should stay outside the core architectural answer unless the question explicitly asks for it?

A. The Great Bath is a public structure whose ritual meaning is inferential. B. Dholavira shows regional adaptation within shared Harappan norms. C. The drainage system is maintainable and city-linked. D. A fully developed single-cause decline theory with detailed political history.

Answer: D. Explanation: Decline theories and extended political chronology belong to other topic boundaries unless the wording specifically demands them.

REMEDIAL PRACTICE - TRAP-FOCUSED DRILLS

Drill 1. What is the best repair for the claim "The citadel proves caste"?

A. Replace it with "the citadel-lower town split is best read as functional zoning." B. Replace it with "the citadel proves a single universal monarchy." C. Replace it with "the citadel is useless evidence." D. Replace it with "the citadel proves temple domination."

Answer: A. Explanation: The corrected line preserves the strength of the evidence without forcing it into a rigid social map.

Drill 2. What is the best repair for the claim "The Great Bath proves a known priesthood"?

A. Keep it unchanged because the ritual role is certain. B. Repair it to: "The Great Bath is a major public water structure; ritual cleansing is plausible, not inscriptionally confirmed." C. Repair it to: "The Great Bath had no public role at all." D. Repair it to: "The Great Bath was definitely a palace moat."

Answer: B. Explanation: This is the disciplined way to preserve both the structure and the inferential limit.

Drill 3. What is the best repair for the claim "All Harappan construction can be described through gypsum mortar"?

A. Replace it with "all Harappan construction was stone-built." B. Replace it with "brick evidence is unimportant." C. Replace it with "standardised baked-brick construction is the safe general claim; technical mortar or waterproofing detail must remain context-specific." D. Replace it with "gypsum mortar proves a named dynasty."

Answer: C. Explanation: The reopened correction specifically requires the general claim to remain on brick standardisation, not on universalised mortar language.

Drill 4. What is the best repair for the claim "Stepwells continue Harappan drains directly"?

A. Replace it with "all later tanks are Harappan." B. Replace it with "Rani-ki-Vav is a Harappan bath." C. Replace it with "water architecture is not worth comparing." D. Replace it with "Harappan and later water structures answer related but distinct problems and should not be merged into one unbroken lineage."

Answer: D. Explanation: The correction preserves comparative value while restoring the functional firewall between civic Harappan systems and later ritual or patron-driven structures.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ - 2025 GS-I

Question: Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. (Answer in 150 words.) **Directive focus:** Discuss = select the main features, arrange them in order, support them with named evidence and end with a qualification.

Examiner-ready model answer: Harappan architecture is best understood as planned civic urbanism. Cities such as Harappa and Mohenjo-daro followed rectangular grids, with roads crossing at right angles, showing deliberate pre-planning. Their raised citadels and larger lower towns indicate functional zoning within the settlement. Public works such as the Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro and structures conventionally identified as granaries reveal organised collective construction. Standardised baked-brick construction, together with private wells, bathing spaces and some stairways in houses, shows that planning extended into domestic life. The drainage system is the most striking feature: house drains linked into covered street drains with cleaning points, proving maintainable civic sanitation. Regional variation strengthens the picture, especially at Dholavira, where reservoirs and fortifications adapted Harappan planning to a different ecology. A careful conclusion must add that no large building has been securely identified as a palace or temple, so Harappan architecture remains impressive but evidence-bound.

Why this earns marks: The answer ranks the features correctly, keeps the language evidence-bound, and uses Dholavira plus the final caveat to move beyond rote textbook listing.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is drainage central to an assessment of Harappan urbanism? Answer in about 150 words. **Demand focus:** Explain significance, not just physical description.

Examiner-ready model answer: Drainage is central because it reveals how Harappan cities organised ordinary urban life into a civic system. The crucial point is not simply that drains existed, but that they were linked and maintainable. Small drains ran from houses into larger street drains, and cleaning points or cesspits were provided at intervals, showing that waste disposal was planned as an urban service rather than left to individual households. This connects private bathing spaces and wells to a larger civic logic. It also explains why Harappan architecture appears more civic than dynastic-monumental in its visible investment: the strongest remains regulate daily life through water control, hygiene and maintenance. Drainage therefore becomes an index of planning, labour coordination and public concern for cleanliness. At the same time, one must avoid overclaim: the system proves coordinated urban management more clearly than it proves the exact institution or political authority that supervised it.

Why this earns marks: The answer moves from form to significance, uses the linked-network logic, and ends with the required qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why Dholavira is indispensable to any account of Harappan architecture. Answer in about 150 words. **Demand focus:** Show how Dholavira changes the civilisational reading, not just why it is famous.

Examiner-ready model answer: Dholavira is indispensable because it prevents Harappan architecture from being reduced to a single Mohenjo-daro template. The site preserves a fortified, multi-part settlement together with an elaborate system of reservoirs and water harvesting, showing that Harappan planning could be adapted to a very different ecology. This widens the civilisational thesis from mere uniformity to standardisation through adaptation. The same broad concerns with order, controlled movement, public works and water management remain visible, but they do not produce identical city plans at every site. UNESCO's official account strengthens this interpretation by recognising Dholavira as a planned Harappan city spanning early, mature and late phases and by highlighting its

water systems. Thus Dholavira is not decorative extra knowledge; it is the evidence that makes the larger Harappan argument more flexible, regional and analytically precise.

Why this earns marks: It uses Dholavira to change the thesis, not merely to add another example.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why must the chronology of Harappan phases be kept distinct from the chronology of discovery and excavation? Answer in about 150 words. **Demand focus:** Prevent anachronism and show methodological clarity.

Examiner-ready model answer: The chronology of Harappan phases and the chronology of discovery must be kept separate because they answer different questions. Early, Mature Urban and Late/Post-Urban Harappan phases describe the civilisation's own historical development and therefore help explain the rise, peak and weakening of its urban architecture. Discovery chronology, by contrast, explains when modern scholarship recovered that evidence: Cunningham noticed a Harappan seal in 1853, Daya Ram Sahni excavated Harappa in 1921, Mohenjo-daro was excavated in the early 1920s, and later work extended the picture to sites such as Dholavira. If the two timelines are merged, students begin to treat excavation dates as if they were civilisational dates or treat modern labels as if they were ancient self-descriptions. Keeping the timelines distinct therefore protects both factual accuracy and interpretive discipline in a Harappan answer.

Why this earns marks: It directly addresses the methodological issue reopened by the user and turns chronology into exam value.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: "Harappan standardisation operated through regional adaptation." Analyse. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand focus: Show common norms and local difference together.

Examiner-ready model answer: Harappan standardisation is visible first in repeated architectural principles. Across major sites one finds right-angled street planning, differentiated settlement zones, repeated brick norms, domestic wells, bathing spaces and linked drainage. These features show that the civilisation possessed a recognisable urban vocabulary. However, the strongest interpretation is not rigid sameness but standardisation through regional adaptation. Mohenjo-daro presents the best-known combination of the Great Bath and sophisticated drainage. Harappa contributes major public platforms and the granary-complex tradition. Dholavira, in a different ecological setting, expands the same planning logic through fortifications, reservoirs and water harvesting. Lothal contributes a basin traditionally called a dockyard, but its debated function itself teaches caution about local forms. Kalibangan confirms that distinctive planning existed within the Harappan world and that regional trajectories mattered. The analytical gain is important. Shared norms suggest coordination or a common technical culture, yet the differences between sites show that Harappan urbanism was never a civilisational photocopy. It solved recurring problems of movement, storage, water and settlement order through local material and ecological choices. Therefore, Harappan architecture should be explained neither as total uniformity nor as disconnected localism, but as a coherent urban tradition capable of regional adjustment.

Why this earns marks: It compares sites under common headings and ends with a balanced thesis.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 15 MARKS

Question: To what extent can architecture reconstruct Harappan society? Answer in about 250 words. **Demand focus:** Grade the evidence; do not give a binary yes/no answer.

Examiner-ready model answer: Architecture can reconstruct Harappan society to a significant but limited extent. It strongly reveals a society capable of planned urban life. Right-angled streets, citadel-lower town division, standardised brick construction, household wells, bathing spaces, linked drains and, at Dholavira, extensive reservoir planning all point to coordinated norms, engineering competence and public concern for water management. Architecture also allows some guarded social inference. Variation in house size and the division between raised public zones and larger residential quarters suggest functional differentiation and possibly unequal access to resources. Large public structures such as the Great Bath or conventionally identified granaries imply collective institutions of some kind. Yet the evidence rapidly weakens when the question shifts from organisation to exact identity. The script remains undeciphered, buildings are not inscriptionally named and the sources explicitly deny confirmed palaces or temples. As a result, architecture cannot securely name rulers, prove a state religion or settle the nature of social

hierarchy. The correct answer is therefore graded: architecture reconstructs civic order and technical capability strongly, social differentiation cautiously, and named political or ritual institutions only very weakly. Its real strength lies in showing how Harappans organised urban life, not in answering every question that their unread script leaves open.

Why this earns marks: It follows a strong-to-weak evidence ladder and answers the exact wording "to what extent".

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare Harappan urban priorities with contemporary monumental traditions. Answer in about 300 words.

Demand focus: Compare visible investment, not civilisational worth.

Examiner-ready model answer: The contrast between Harappan urbanism and contemporary monumental traditions is best understood as a difference in visible architectural priority rather than a simple contrast between "advanced" and "backward" cultures. In the Harappan case, the strongest evidence lies in planned civic infrastructure. Right-angled streets, citadel-lower town zoning, standardised baked-brick construction, house-linked drainage, wells, bathing spaces, public baths and, at Dholavira, large reservoirs show a civilisation that invested heavily in regulating everyday urban life. Even the Great Bath, the most famous Harappan public structure, fits a collective water-and-civic setting more than a securely identified royal or temple complex. By contrast, the most famous Egyptian and Mesopotamian remains foreground pyramids, ziggurats and palace-temple systems that make dynastic or sacred authority archaeologically explicit. This difference matters analytically. Harappan planning still implies coordination, labour mobilisation and institutional order, but because the script is undeciphered and buildings remain unnamed, the exact political form behind that order cannot be recovered with equal confidence. Therefore the safest comparative conclusion is not that Harappans lacked power or belief, but that their surviving architecture projects civic order more strongly than named dynasty or cult. Judged by monumental display, Harappan architecture can seem restrained; judged by the engineering of everyday urban life, it is one of the most systematic traditions of the Bronze Age.

Why this earns marks: It compares like with like, preserves evidentiary caution and converts description into argument.

ORIGINAL MAINS 7 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine water architecture in the Harappan city and distinguish it from later Indian water structures.

Answer in about 300 words. **Demand focus:** Explain the Harappan system first, then establish the firewall against false continuity.

Examiner-ready model answer: Water architecture in the Harappan city was civic, distributed and infrastructural. At the domestic level, houses frequently included private wells and designated bathing spaces. At the street level, small drains connected these spaces to larger covered drains with cleaning points, proving that sanitation was designed as a maintainable urban system. At the public level, Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath demonstrates carefully organised collective water architecture, while Dholavira expands the scale through dams, reservoirs and water harvesting adapted to a difficult ecology. Together these features show that Harappan water architecture addressed supply, circulation, storage and cleanliness across the settlement as a whole. Later Indian water structures often answered different architectural questions. Rani-ki-Vav represents the stepwell tradition; Modhera's Surya Kund, the Hoysala kalyani and Potramarai Kulam belong to temple-centred or ceremonial settings; Mandu's baulis highlight storage within later palace-fort environments; and the Sudarshana lake record at Junagadh shows long-duration state repair of a water reservoir. The crucial distinction is functional and chronological. Harappan systems were embedded in city planning and everyday civic regulation, whereas later stepwells, temple tanks and baulis were often ritual, commemorative, patron-specific or regionally hydraulic structures. Similar concern with water does not establish a single uninterrupted lineage. A good answer therefore compares purposes, settings and users rather than forcing a neat line from Harappan drains to all later Indian water monuments.

Why this earns marks: It keeps Harappan evidence central, then distinguishes later categories through function and chronology rather than through vague similarity.

TIMELINE, KEYWORD AND PARAGRAPH-BUILDING DRILLS

Drill A - Timeline sorting

Task: Arrange these cards into two correct rails: 1853 seal notice; Mature Urban Harappan peak; 2021 UNESCO inscription for Dholavira; Early Harappan foundations; 1921 Harappa excavation; Late/Post-Urban change. **Solved answer:**

- Archaeological rail: Early Harappan foundations -> Mature Urban Harappan peak -> Late/Post-Urban change.
- Modern recovery / heritage rail: 1853 seal notice -> 1921 Harappa excavation -> 2021 UNESCO inscription for Dholavira.

Drill B - Must-write keyword bank for the 2025 PYQ

Task: Pick five must-write expressions for a 150-word answer. **Solved answer:** rectangular grid; functional zoning; maintainable drainage; standardised baked-brick construction; evidentiary caution.

Drill C - Build one paragraph from notes

Task notes: right-angled roads; citadel/lower town; Great Bath; no confirmed palace or temple. **Model paragraph:** Harappan architecture reveals deliberate urban order through right-angled roads and a clear distinction between an upraised citadel and a larger lower town. This zoned plan is reinforced by public structures such as the Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro, which shows substantial collective investment in water architecture. Yet the same evidence requires caution, because no major structure has been securely identified as a palace or temple. Thus the architecture strongly proves planning and civic organisation, while leaving the exact nature of political and religious institutions only partly inferential.